

*Dummies* and *Why We Buy*, along with delving into research related to consumer behavior and shopping. While Procter & Gamble had created a research department as far back as 1923, consumer behavior remained a relatively new field of study in the mid-1960s. It has now become one of the main topics in contemporary marketing education at universities and colleges, with several books focusing on the topic as well as magazines like *The Journal of Consumer Psychology* which include a dozen new research studies in each issue.

In layman's terms, the study of consumer behavior means getting into the head of the consumer to figure out the motives behind their purchases. We've all heard someone say something along the lines of, "I *need* that purse," or "those shoes," or "that wide-screen television," things they most definitely do not actually *need*. What we do *need* is food, water, and shelter. There are certainly plenty of marketing techniques employed to get us to buy a particular product, especially in regards to the first item in that category: food.

Companies have ample opportunities to promote their products. Where is the milk located in the grocery store where you shop? Everyone needs milk, but if that is all we plan to buy, we are forced to go through the entire store to get to the dairy case in the back. Need to pick up a prescription at the local drugstore? The pharmacy is also located at the back of the store, ensuring you must pass several shelves of strategically placed merchandise and sale racks of gifts you didn't even know you wanted, but suddenly appeal to you. When you reach the checkout, displays of candy, gum, breath